

How to Play CyberArena

A Complete Beginner's Guide - Simple & Easy!

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Getting Started

First Time Setup

1. **Launch the game** - Open CyberArena on your computer
2. **Create your account** - Click "Sign Up" and enter:
 - Your email address
 - A password (at least 6 characters)
 - A username (this is what other players will see)
3. **Choose your avatar** - Pick a cool profile picture
4. **You're ready!** - You'll see the main menu

Logging In

- Already have an account? Just click "Login"
 - Enter your email and password
 - Click the login button and you're in!
-

Main Menu (Landing Page)

When you first enter the game, you'll see the **Landing Page**. Think of it as your home base!

What You'll See:

- **Your Profile** (top section)
 - Your username and avatar
 - Your level (you start at Level 1)
 - Your XP (experience points)

- **Main Buttons:**

-  **Tutorial Mode** - Learn cybersecurity basics
-  **Code Breaker** - Play the typing battle game
-  **Akashic TCG** - Play the card game (coming soon!)
-  **Chat** - Talk to other players
-  **Friends** - See your friend list

Learning Path: Beginner to Intermediate

Why Start Here?

Tutorials teach you about **cybersecurity** (internet safety and hacking concepts) in a fun, interactive way. Plus, you earn XP to level up!

Recommended Learning Order:

Follow this path for the best learning experience:

STEP 1: Start with Beginner Tutorials (Complete all 5)

1.  **Cybersecurity Fundamentals** ← START HERE!
2.  **Network Basics**
3.  **Encryption Basics**
4.  **Malware Types**
5.  **Phishing Lab**

STEP 2: Move to Intermediate (When ready) 6.  **Hands-On Malware Removal Lab** ← Real CMD commands!

STEP 3: Master Advanced (For experts) 7.  **Malware Incident Response** (Coming soon!) 8.  **Trojan Horse Tutorial** (Coming soon!)

How to Access Tutorials:

1. Click the "**Tutorial Mode**" button on the landing page
2. Choose your difficulty level:
 -  **Beginner** - Perfect for new players! (Everyone starts here)
 -  **Intermediate** - Real hands-on practice with commands
 -  **Advanced** - Expert-level simulations

XP Rewards:

- **200 XP** - Score 100% (perfect!)
- **150 XP** - Score 75-99% (great!)
- **100 XP** - Score 50-74% (good!)
- **0 XP** - Score below 50% (try again!)

Beginner Tutorials - Complete Guide

Tutorial 1: Cybersecurity Fundamentals

What You'll Learn: The foundation of cybersecurity - The CIA Triad and Threat Models

Duration: 10 minutes | **Questions:** 4 | **Max Score:** 200 points

What This Tutorial Teaches:

Part 1: The CIA Triad Learn the three pillars of cybersecurity:

1. **Confidentiality = Keeping Secrets**

- Only authorized people see information
- Examples: Passwords, medical records, bank accounts
- Protection: Encryption, passwords, access controls
- Breach example: Hacker steals customer database

2. **Integrity = Preventing Tampering**

- Data stays accurate and unmodified
- Examples: Bank balances, software downloads, prescriptions
- Protection: Digital signatures, checksums, version control
- Breach example: Hacker changes your bank balance

3. **Availability = Keeping Services Running**

- Systems work when you need them
- Examples: Websites online 24/7, ATMs dispense cash
- Protection: Backup servers, DDoS protection, disaster recovery
- Breach example: DDoS attack crashes website

Part 2: Threat Model Understand the difference between threats and vulnerabilities:

- **Threat** = Potential danger (hackers, malware, disasters)
- **Vulnerability** = Weakness (outdated software, weak passwords)
- **Risk** = Threat × Vulnerability × Impact

The Quiz Questions:

Q1: A hacker steals your password database. Which CIA principle is violated?

- Answer: **Confidentiality** (data was kept secret but got exposed)

Q2: An attacker modifies your website to show fake information. Which is violated?

- Answer: **Integrity** (data was changed/tampered with)

Q3: A DDoS attack makes your website unreachable. Which is violated?

- Answer: **Availability** (service is no longer accessible)

Q4: What's the difference between Threat and Vulnerability?

- Answer: **Threat = potential danger, Vulnerability = weakness**

How to Play:

1. Read each section carefully
 2. Click "Next" to move through the learning sections
 3. When you reach the quiz, answer all 4 questions
 4. Each correct answer = +50 points
 5. Score 150+ points to get full XP!
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Tutorial 2: Network Basics 🌐

What You'll Learn: How computers communicate - IP addresses, ports, and protocols

Duration: 10 minutes | **Questions:** 3 | **Max Score:** 150 points

What This Tutorial Teaches:

Part 1: IP Addresses Learn the "addresses" of computers:

- **Private IP (Local Network):** 192.168.x.x, 10.x.x.x
 - Only visible on your home/office WiFi
 - Example: Your laptop = 192.168.1.100
- **Public IP (Internet):** Assigned by your internet provider
 - Example: Your router = 45.67.89.123
 - Visible to the entire internet

Part 2: Ports Think of ports as "apartment numbers" on a computer:

Good Ports (Normal):

- Port 80 = HTTP (websites)
- Port 443 = HTTPS (secure websites)
- Port 22 = SSH (remote login)

Suspicious Ports (Hackers!):

- Port 4444 = Common backdoor
- Port 31337 = "Elite" hacker port

Part 3: Protocols Rules for how computers talk:

- **HTTP** = Not secure (anyone can read)
- **HTTPS** = Encrypted (safe for passwords)
- **TCP** = Reliable delivery
- **UDP** = Fast but unreliable

The Quiz Questions:

Q1: You see traffic to 45.33.32.156:4444. What does port 4444 mean?

- Answer: **Suspicious backdoor port** (not normal!)

Q2: What's the difference between public and private IP?

- Answer: **Public = internet, Private = local network only**

Q3: Which protocol is secure (encrypted)?

- Answer: **HTTPS** (the 'S' means Secure!)

How to Play:

1. Learn about IP addresses and ports
 2. Understand normal vs suspicious connections
 3. Answer 3 questions
 4. Each correct = +50 points
-

Tutorial 3: Encryption Basics

What You'll Learn: Secret codes and how encryption protects (and attacks) data

Duration: 12 minutes | **Interactive Challenge** | **Max Score:** 100 points

What This Tutorial Teaches:

Part 1: What is Encryption? Turning readable text into unreadable code:

- **Plaintext:** "HELLO"
- **Encrypted:** "KHOOR"
- Need a KEY to decrypt it back

Part 2: Caesar Cipher Demo Try encrypting messages yourself!

- Each letter shifts by a number (the key)
- Key = 3 means A→D, B→E, C→F
- Example: "HELLO" with key 3 = "KHOOR"

Part 3: Decryption Challenge YOU decrypt a secret message!

- **Encrypted Message:** WKLV LV VHFUHW
- **Key:** 3
- **Your Task:** Shift each letter BACKWARDS by 3
- **Answer:** "THIS IS SECRET"

Part 4: Why Ransomware is Scary Learn the difference:

- **Caesar Cipher:** Only 26 possible keys (easy to crack!)
- **Ransomware (AES-256):** 2^{256} keys = impossible to crack!
 - Would take billions of years to try all keys

- Attacker keeps the only key
- Demands payment to decrypt your files

Your Defense Against Ransomware:

- ☒ Daily backups (multiple copies)
- ☒ Air-gapped backups (offline storage)
- ☒ Cloud + local copies
- ☒ NEVER pay the ransom!

How to Play:

1. Watch the encryption demo
2. Try encrypting messages yourself
3. Solve the decryption challenge
4. **Scoring:**
 - Correct on 1st try = 100 points
 - Each wrong attempt = -10 points
 - After 3 tries = Auto-show answer, minimum 50 points

Tutorial 4: Malware Types

What You'll Learn: Identify 6 types of malware by their symptoms

Duration: 90 seconds (TIMED!) | **Drag & Drop Game** | **Max Score:** 100 points

What This Tutorial Teaches:

Learn to identify malware by reading "incident reports":

VIRUS

- Attaches to files (.exe, .doc)
- Spreads via USB drives, email
- Requires user to run the infected file

WORM

- Spreads AUTOMATICALLY across networks
- No user interaction needed
- Consumes bandwidth

TROJAN

- Disguises as legitimate software
- Creates backdoors for hackers
- Remote access tool

RANSOMWARE

- Encrypts all your files

- Demands Bitcoin payment
- Changes desktop wallpaper to ransom note

SPYWARE

- Secretly monitors your activity
- Steals passwords (keyloggers)
- Runs hidden in background

ADWARE

- Shows constant pop-up ads
- Changes browser homepage
- Tracks your browsing habits

How to Play:

1. **Read 6 incident reports** (symptoms of malware)
2. **Drag the correct malware type** to each report
3. **Beat the 90-second timer!**
4. **Example Report:**

Symptoms:

- All files encrypted with .locked extension
- Ransom note demanding Bitcoin
- Desktop wallpaper changed

Answer:  RANSOMWARE

Scoring:

Completion Score = (Reports Solved / 6) × 50

Time Bonus = (Time Left / 90) × 50

Final Score = Completion + Time Bonus

Example: Solve all 6 with 45 seconds left = 75/100 points!

Tutorial 5: Phishing Lab

What You'll Learn: Spot fake emails and avoid scams

Duration: 90 seconds (TIMED!) | **Email Classification** | **Max Score:** 1200 points

What This Tutorial Teaches:

Learn to identify PHISHING emails by spotting red flags:

🚩 Red Flags (PHISHING):

- Generic greetings ("Dear Customer")
- Urgent threatening language ("Account suspended!")
- Fake domains (paypa1.tk not paypal.com)
- Suspicious links (bit.ly, weird URLs)
- Requests for passwords/credit cards
- Too-good-to-be-true offers ("You won \$1,000,000!")

✅ Legitimate Signs (SAFE):

- Uses your real name
- Official company domain (@netflix.com, @amazon.com)
- Specific details (order numbers, dates)
- No urgent action required
- No requests for sensitive info

Example Emails:

Email 1: PayPal PHISHING 🚩

From: security@paypa1-secure.tk
Subject: URGENT: Verify Your Account Now!

Your PayPal account will be SUSPENDED in 24 hours!
Click here: <http://paypal-verify.tk/login>

Red Flags: Fake domain (.tk), typo (paypa1), urgent threat, suspicious link **Answer:** PHISHING

Email 2: Netflix Legitimate ✅

From: noreply@netflix.com
Subject: Your Netflix receipt

Hi Sarah,

Your \$15.99 payment was processed on Nov 29, 2025.
Watch history: Stranger Things S4, The Crown S6

Legitimate Signs: Real domain, uses name, specific details, no action needed **Answer:** SAFE

How to Play:

1. **Read 8 emails** carefully
2. **Click SAFE or PHISHING** for each
3. **Beat the 90-second timer!**
4. **Learn from feedback** after each answer

Scoring:

Correct = +150 points
Wrong = -50 points
Max Score = 1200 points (8 × 150)

Grade Scale:
90%+ (1080+) = Grade A
80-89% = Grade B
70-79% = Grade C

Pro Tip: Look for fake domains and urgent language first!

🕒 Intermediate Tutorial - Complete Guide

Tutorial 6: Hands-On Malware Removal Lab 🔧

What You'll Learn: Remove malware using real Windows CMD commands

Duration: 15-20 minutes | **Interactive Simulation** | **Max Score:** 1000 points

⚠️ **This is hands-on practice!** You'll type REAL commands to remove malware.

What This Tutorial Teaches:

Experience a malware infection from start to finish, then learn to remove it!

The Story:

1. You download a fake game installer
2. It's actually malware (Trojan!)
3. Malware infects your computer
4. YOU use CMD commands to detect and remove it

Phase 1: The Download (Victim Experience)

You see: "Download Free Game - SuperGame.exe"

- You click and run it
- Trojan activates!
- **Malware installed:** `malware.exe`, `svchost32.exe`, `updater.exe`

Phase 2: The Infection (What Happened)

Malware Actions:

- ☒ Creates backdoor (port 4444)
- ☒ Connects to hacker's server (C2: 45.33.32.156)
- ☒ Adds registry key for auto-start

- ☒ Hides in AppData folder
- ☒ Creates scheduled task

You notice:

- Computer running slow
- Firewall alerts
- Strange network connections

Phase 3: DETECTION - Find the Malware**Your Commands:**

Command 1: **tasklist** See all running programs:

```
explorer.exe      Normal
svchost.exe       Normal
malware.exe       ⚠ SUSPICIOUS!
svchost32.exe     ⚠ FAKE svchost!
updater.exe       ⚠ SUSPICIOUS!
```

Command 2: **netstat -ano** Check network connections:

```
192.168.1.100 → 8.8.8.8:443      [Google - Normal]
192.168.1.100 → 45.33.32.156:443 ⚠ [C2 SERVER - MALWARE!]
```

Command 3: **dir %appdata%** Check AppData folder:

```
malware.exe      120 KB  ⚠ MALICIOUS
svchost32.exe    95 KB   ⚠ MALICIOUS
```

☒ **Completion Bonus: +100 points**

Phase 4: CONTAINMENT - Stop the Malware**Your Commands:**

Kill the processes:

```
taskkill /F /IM malware.exe
taskkill /F /IM svchost32.exe
taskkill /F /IM updater.exe
```

Block the hacker's server:

```
netsh advfirewall firewall add rule name="blockmfw" dir=out remoteip=45.33.32.156  
action=block
```

Result: ☒ Malware stopped! C2 connection blocked!

☒ **Completion Bonus: +100 points**

Phase 5: ERADICATION - Remove All Traces

Your Commands:

Remove auto-start registry key:

```
reg delete "HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run" /v "WindowsUpdate"  
/f
```

Delete malware files:

```
del /F /Q "%appdata%\malware.exe"  
del /F /Q "%appdata%\svchost32.exe"
```

Remove scheduled task:

```
schtasks /delete /tn "SystemUpdate" /f
```

Result: ☒ All malware traces removed! System clean!

☒ **Completion Bonus: +150 points**

Command Reference Sheet (Available During Game):

Detection:

- `tasklist` - List running processes
- `netstat -ano` - Show network connections
- `dir %appdata%` - Check AppData folder

Containment:

- `taskkill /F /IM [name]` - Kill process
- `netsh advfirewall firewall add rule...` - Block IP

Eradication:

- `reg delete...` - Remove registry keys

- `del /F /Q [path]` - Delete files
- `schtasks /delete...` - Remove scheduled tasks

Scoring System:

Starting Score: 1000 points
Wrong command: -10 points each
Detection done: +100 points
Containment done: +100 points
Eradication done: +150 points
Time bonus: +0 to +180 (if under 3 minutes)

Grade Scale:

900+: S-RANK (Cyber Expert!)
750-899: A-RANK (Security Pro!)
600-749: B-RANK (Good Work!)
<600: C-RANK (Keep Learning!)

How to Play:

1. **Watch the infection happen** (victim experience)
2. **Phase 3:** Type detection commands to find malware
3. **Phase 4:** Type containment commands to stop it
4. **Phase 5:** Type eradication commands to remove it
5. **Get instant feedback** on each command
6. **Hints appear** after 15 seconds if you're stuck (no penalty!)

Pro Tips:

- Copy commands carefully (spelling matters!)
- Use hints if stuck (they don't lower your score)
- Type commands in the right phase
- Complete all phases to win!

Playing Code Breaker

What is Code Breaker?

It's a **1v1 typing battle game!** You race against another player by typing code accurately. Every correct character you type **damages your opponent**. The goal is to reduce their health to zero or finish the code first!

Step-by-Step Guide:

1 Join the Lobby

- Click "**Code Breaker**" from the landing page

- You'll see the **Lobby** with a list of available rooms
- Wait a few seconds for rooms to load

[2] Create or Join a Room

Option A: Create Your Own Room

1. Click "**Create Room**" button
2. Type a room name (e.g., "My First Game")
3. Click "**Create**"
4. Wait in the room for another player to join

Option B: Join Someone's Room

1. Look at the list of available rooms
2. Find a room with 1 player waiting
3. Click "**Join**" next to that room
4. You'll enter the room!

[3] In the Room (Waiting Area)

- You'll see two player cards:
 - **Left card** = Host (room creator)
 - **Right card** = Client (person who joined)
- **If you're the Client:**
 - Click the "**READY**" button when you're ready to play
 - Wait for the host to start
- **If you're the Host:**
 - Wait for the other player to click "Ready"
 - When they're ready, click "**START MATCH**"

[4] Loading Screen

- Both players see a loading screen
- Progress bars show when each player is ready
- **Countdown:** 3... 2... 1... and the game starts!

[5] Playing the Game

Game Screen:

- **Top bars:** Your health (left) and opponent's health (right)
- **Center:** A code snippet you need to type
- **Timer:** 3 minutes to complete the match

How to Play:

1. **Type the code EXACTLY as you see it**
 - Match every letter, space, and punctuation

- Capital letters matter! (A is different from a)
- Don't paste - you must type!

2. What Happens When You Type:

-  **Correct character:**
 - You get +3 points
 - Your opponent loses 2 health
 - Green flash animation
-  **Wrong character:**
 - You lose -3 points
 - The current line restarts
 - Red flash animation
 - Try again from the start of that line!

3. Watch the health bars:

- Your health stays at 100 (you can't hurt yourself)
- Opponent's health drops when you type correctly
- The bar shakes when they take damage!

Winning the Game: You win if:

-  Your opponent's health reaches 0
-  You finish typing the entire code first
-  Time runs out and you have more health (or higher score if health is tied)

After the Game:

- You'll see the results screen
- You can return to the room for a rematch
- Or leave and join a different game

Leaving a Room

- Click the "**Leave**" button anytime
- You'll return to the lobby
- Can join or create a new room!

Chat & Friends

Opening Chat

1. Click the "**Chat**" button on the landing page
2. You'll see a list of players

Sending Messages

1. **Search for a player** by typing their username
2. **Click on their name** to open the chat
3. **Type your message** in the box at the bottom
4. **Press Enter** or click "Send"
5. Messages appear instantly!

Unread Messages

- Look for **red badges** with numbers (e.g., "3")
- This shows how many unread messages you have
- The badge disappears when you read the messages

💡 Tips for New Players

General Tips:

1. **Start with tutorials** - They're fun and help you level up fast!
2. **Practice typing** - Code Breaker rewards accuracy, not just speed
3. **Be patient** - Wait for the loading screens, they ensure both players are ready
4. **Have fun!** - It's okay to make mistakes, everyone is learning

Code Breaker Tips:

1. **Read the code first** - Take 2-3 seconds to see what you're typing
2. **Type slowly and accurately** - Wrong keys restart the line and waste time
3. **Watch for spaces and capitals** - They count as characters too!
4. **Stay calm** - If you make a mistake, just restart the line and try again
5. **Keep an eye on both health bars** - Know when you're winning or need to speed up

Typing Strategy:

- **Don't rush** - Accuracy beats speed every time
- **Breathe** - Take your time on each character
- **Learn from errors** - If you keep mistyping the same spot, slow down there
- **Focus on YOUR code** - Don't worry too much about the opponent's health

Level Up Faster:

- ☒ Complete tutorials (earn XP)
- ☒ Win Code Breaker matches (earn XP)
- ☒ Play daily (consistent practice helps!)

🔗 Quick Reference

Game Modes:

Mode	What It Is	Best For
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Mode	What It Is	Best For
Tutorials	Learn cybersecurity concepts	New players, earning XP
Code Breaker	1v1 typing battle	Competitive fun, testing skills
Chat	Message other players	Making friends, coordinating games

Code Breaker Stats:

- **Starting Health:** 100 HP (both players)
- **Match Time:** 3 minutes
- **Correct Character:** +3 score, 2 damage to opponent
- **Wrong Character:** -3 score, restart current line
- **Win Condition:** First to 0 opponent health, or finish code first

🔗 Common Questions

Q: Do I need two computers to play?

A: No! You can play with anyone online. Just join a room or wait for someone to join yours.

Q: What if nobody joins my room?

A: Wait a minute or two. You can also ask in chat! Or join someone else's room instead.

Q: Can I play against my friend?

A: Yes! Create a room and tell your friend the room name. They can search for it in the lobby.

Q: What happens if I disconnect during a game?

A: The game will end and you'll return to the lobby. Try to play with a stable internet connection!

Q: How do I get better at Code Breaker?

A: Practice typing code! Start slow, focus on accuracy. Speed will come naturally over time.

Q: Are there more games coming?

A: Yes! Akashic TCG (card game) is coming soon!

🎮 Ready to Play?

Now you know everything you need to get started! Here's what to do:

1. ☒ **Login** to your account
2. ☒ **Try a tutorial** to learn and earn XP
3. ☒ **Jump into Code Breaker** for your first typing battle
4. ☒ **Make friends** in chat
5. ☒ **Have fun!** 🎯

Remember: Everyone starts as a beginner. Take your time, learn the basics, and enjoy the journey!

Happy Gaming! See you in CyberArena! 🗨️

